

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 8 5
♥ A Q 8 5
♦ 5 4 3
♣ Q J 10 2

♠ A Q 10 6

♥ 7

♦ K J 9 6 2

♣ K 6 5



♠ 9 4 3

♥ 9 6 4

♦ A Q 10 8

♣ 9 8 3

♠ K J 7 2

♥ K J 10 3 2

♦ 7

♣ A 7 4

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♦

Pass

1 ♥

Pass

1 ♠

Pass

4 ♠

All Pass

4 ♠ by North

As you can imagine, declarer will be in a whole lot of trouble.

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 4 ♠

Lead any ♠.

You have ♦ winners, but dummy will surely be short since he has at least 8 cards in the Major suits.

Partner has whatever ♥ strength your side possesses.

It is very likely that declarer will want to do some cross-trumping. To try to cut that down your best lead is a trump.

Just imagine that declarer wins the first ♠ in his hand and plays a ♥ to dummy's honors. West will win and play another trump. Whenever you win your first ♦ you will play your last trump.

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K J 9 4 3

♥ 6 5 3

♦ 8 2

♣ 10 6 2

♠ 8 7 2

♥ K 8 7

♦ K Q J

♣ A 8 5 4



♠ 10 5

♥ J 10 4 2

♦ 9 6 5 4 3

♣ J 9

♠ A Q 6

♥ A Q 9

♦ A 10 7

♣ K Q 7 3

West

North

East

South

Pass

6NT

2NT

All Pass

6NT by South

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 6NT

Lead the ♥6.

You held this identical hand in Deal 3. The declarer was playing 3NT and the best lead was the ♠4, fourth down.

It's different when the contract is 6NT. Against 6NT you should make a passive lead, which means don't underlead any honors. Against 6NT you have little chance of establishing a suit to win four or five tricks. Instead, you just want to try to not give declarer an undeserved trick.

So any passive lead would be OK, you pick the ♥ just because they are less likely to have an unbid 4-card Major in either hand.

Declarer has 11 winners sitting there; if you had led a low ♠ you would have handed him his 12 trick on a platter.

Board 5

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ Q 9 7 6 3

♥ 10 4 3

♦ 4

♣ 9 8 4 3

♠ J 10

♥ K Q J

♦ A Q J 9 8 7

♣ J 5



♠ K 8 5 4

♥ 8 6 5 2

♦ K 6 2

♣ 10 2

♠ A 2

♥ A 9 7

♦ 10 5 3

♣ A K Q 7 6

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♦

Pass

2 ♣

Pass

3 ♦

Pass

4NT

Pass

5 ♦

Pass

6 ♦

All Pass

6 ♦ by North